

The Berlin look This couple, from a 1920 sheet-music cover, is dressed in the height of fashion. She wears a long jersey over a very short skirt, while he has belted his trenchcoat at just the right height and brushed his hair back aviator-style.

1920

Long jersey with hem in contrasting colour

Short, pleated skirt

Dark stockings

Soft toque

Fox neckpiece

Narrow trousers

Wide-skirted trenchcoat

1925

Ornamented bandeau

Ostrich-feather fan

Asymmetrical dropped waist

Tiered skirt

Skirt lower at back

Window shopping This mannequin, displayed in a draper's shop window, perfectly conveys the fashionable silhouette and showcases popular accessories of the period, such as the long pearl necklace and the ostrich-feather fan.

Soft, wavy hairstyle

Shoulder straps and belt encrusted with jewels

Feather boa

1935

Fluid fabric

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In 1924 Eric Charell, director of a large theatre in Berlin, produced his first revue. Much of its success was due to the appearance of the famous Tiller Girls from London, who dazzled audiences with their synchronized movements. Troupes danced in identical costumes such as these skimpy ensembles with short hemlines, playful top hats, and tap shoes. One critic wrote that "the rhythm, the lightness, the exactness are electrifying".

Lamé German actress Brigitte Helm's choice of shimmering lamé might be related to the title of the science fiction film *Gold*, in which she starred in 1934. Metallic fabrics like lamé draped over the body and caught the light on camera.